



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of The Rogue Valley
School Website: <https://www.chestertonroguevalley.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of the Rogue Valley (a Catholic, classical high school located in Medford, Oregon) presents a robust classical-education profile with clear signposts of the six classical elements. Public materials consistently emphasize Catholic theological formation, liturgical life, and virtue formation; a mission carved around the cultivation of intellect, character, and spirituality; integration of liberal arts, history, and Great Books; a pedagogy that foregrounds memory, chant, and Socratic/seminar-style inquiry; and strong parental engagement as part of a living, communally formed education. Multiple public pages describe a curriculum and culture built on the classics, the great conversation, and the integration of faith and reason, with explicit instances of liturgy, prayer, chanting, and a strong emphasis on virtue.

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are foregrounded through explicit Catholic liturgy, theology, prayer life, and a sacramental worldview, including daily prayer, Mass, liturgical rhythm, and the imago Dei framing of education.
- The school's stated aim centers on formation (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) rather than merely information or career outcomes, with the Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) highlighted as the core objective.
- Curriculum and Great Books/Great Conversation ideas are present (integrated liberal arts approach, Latin, history, philosophy, and the humanities), with explicit reference to reading original texts and engaging in a classical dialogue.
- Pedagogy features lift-and-separate elements of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and Socratic/seminar-style inquiry; memorization and liturgical/chanting practices are invoked as part of memory-work and formation.
- Faculty signals include named leadership (Headmaster) and a culture of mentorship and formation, with emphasis on a coherent school identity; however, explicit language about the faculty as "living curriculum" is less prominent in public materials.
- Parent and community partnership is a stated priority (parents as co-educators, parent formation, open campus/visits, and family involvement), with ongoing opportunities for engagement described in public materials.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL. The school demonstrates many core indicators of classical education (Catholic, moral-virtue formation; Great Books orientation; traditional pedagogical modes; liturgical life; parental partnership). The strength is clearest in religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, and pedagogy. The faculty portrayal is present but less explicitly framed as the "living curriculum" in public materials, and while parental partnership is evidenced, the depth of that partnership (as co-teachers and ongoing formation) could be strengthened in public-facing communications. The aggregate picture remains solidly CLASSICAL, with Element 5 (Faculty) the most nuanced element (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Catholic liturgy, theology, Mass, liturgical life, daily prayer, and sacramental framing are repeatedly described; spiritual formation is central to daily life and identity.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, Mass, reverence, wonder, and sacred music; negative indicators (secular relativism, values-neutrality) are notably absent in public materials. Estimated keyword hits: strong (6–8 positives, 0 negatives).
 - Why this rating: The public materials consistently anchor education in transcendental, theological, and liturgical foundations, with explicit emphasis on virtue and sacred aims. This aligns squarely with the classical framework’s religious/metaphysical core.
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission statements emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of human excellence; the “Three Pillars” (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) foreground purpose beyond job preparation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé, great conversation; Negative: none relevant to this category in public materials. Estimated hits: strong (5–7 positives, 0 negatives).
 - Why this rating: The school explicitly centers formation and virtue as telos, with textual references to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable; this is classic in the classical-education rubric.
 - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Curriculum communicates liberal arts framing (grammar/logic/rhetoric; history through all disciplines; Great Books/great conversation; Latin and languages; integrated disciplines). The “Curriculum Overview” and related materials show emphasis on the liberal arts and classical texts.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords found include Seven Liberal Arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; history; Latin; memory/recitation; sacred art/music. Negative indicators (e.g., project-based, social-studies-only framing) are not evident in public materials. Estimated hits: strong (6–8 positives, 0 negatives).
 - Why this rating: The curriculum text and program descriptions align with classic liberal-arts pedagogy, the Great Books ethos, and language study; explicit references to the Great Conversation and classical canon bolster the rating.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials describe Socratic discussion/seminars, memorization and chanting, memory-rich pedagogy, and the progression to rhetoric and oratory; use of both contemplative (Scholé) and rigorous modes is noted.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic seminar, memorization/recitation, chanting, rest/wonder, upper-school rhetoric; negative signals (e.g., exclusive emphasis on experiential/project-based learning) are not shown; overall strong alignment with classical pedagogy. Estimated hits: strong (6–8 positives, 0–1 weak or neutral mentions).
 - Why this rating: The materials emphasize a dual cadence of contemplative/wonderful lower-division activities and high-school seminars, debates, and rhetoric training—central to classical pedagogy.
 - Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials identify leadership and faculty roles (Headmaster, faculty pages, and teacher postings), with an emphasis on mentorship, formation, and shared identity; explicit language about the faculty as the “living curriculum” is less overt in public pages, though the ethos of virtue-mentoring and communal teacher-student alignment appears.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum (conceptually present in the rubric, but not strongly asserted in site text), portrait of teacher, collegial culture; Negative indicators: explicit phrasing of “living curriculum” is not strongly present in public materials; thus, partial alignment. Estimated hits: moderate positives (2–4), 0 clear negatives.
 - Why this rating: The school communicates strong faculty leadership and mentorship in a traditional sense, but the explicit articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum or a fully developed faculty-formation program is not as prominent as other categories. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

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- Evidence: The school presents parent involvement as a core element (parents as co-teachers, parent formation, open visits, enrollment events, family engagement). Public materials show community and parent-partnership signals, with events and communications inviting parent participation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, open campus, parent engagement; no explicit negative indicators in public communications. Estimated hits: strong (4–6 positives, 0 negatives).
 - Why this rating: The explicit emphasis on parental partnership and family involvement aligns with classical education norms around forming a community of learners with family engagement.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school presents a consistent classical-Catholic profile across four categories (Religious and Meta-physical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy). Element 5 (Faculty) is the most nuanced area, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating, while Element 6 (Parents & Community) aligns strongly with classical practice. Taken together, Chesterton Academy Rogue Valley weighs heavily CLASSICAL overall, with a defined path toward stronger articulation of faculty-as-living-curriculum and deeper parent-co-teaching practices that could be showcased more explicitly in public communications.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category)

- For Element 5 (Faculty): More explicit articulation of the faculty as a “living curriculum” and the role of teachers as mentors and exemplars in public communications. Develop and publish a clear, public-facing statement describing teacher profiles, professional formation in classical pedagogy, and a faculty-model narrative (e.g., portraits of teachers as exemplars, pedagogical training in classical methods, professional development focused on Socratic and Scholé practices). This will strengthen the perception of the faculty as a core element of the curriculum.
- For Element 5 and cross-category alignment: Expand statements about teacher formation, mentorship culture, and collaborative professional life (e.g., seminar-style faculty meetings, teacher-student mentorship models) to reinforce the living-curriculum concept.
- For Element 1–4: Consider adding explicit, public-facing statements that connect daily liturgical life, Great Books/Great Conversation, and Socratic pedagogy to concrete classroom practices (with examples or vignettes) to further demonstrate “classical” alignment in everyday teaching, not only in overarching descriptions.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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